

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

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The Hearth's chicken, dancing in the rain.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

63° / 56°

Rain

Sunrise 6:17 AM · Sunset 6:13 PM

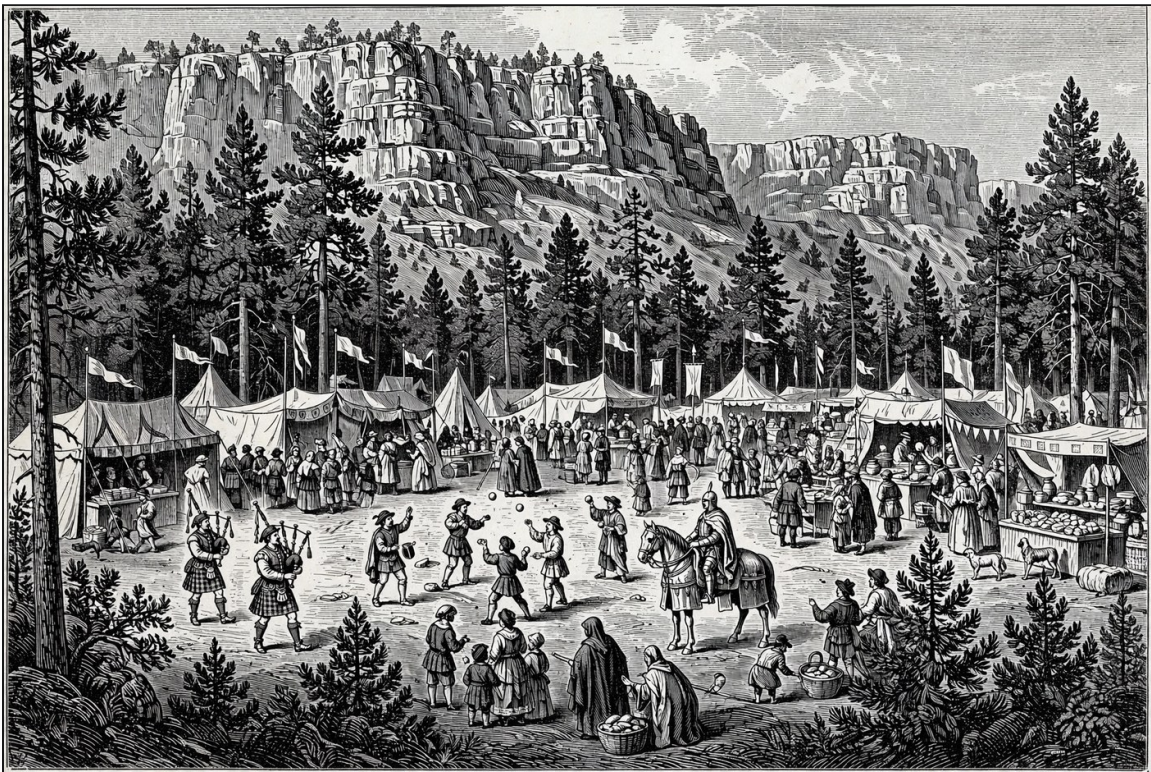
Tomorrow — Thunderstorms, 61/51

AROUND THE HOLD · THE WEEK AHEAD

Faire Week Falls Upon the Holds



By the Dude — Payson, Ariz.



The North Inch Renaissance Faire raises its banners beneath the Rim — bagpipes, jugglers, and a knight of the lists.

PAYSON — Hail and well met, wayfarers, on a rain-washed Monday morn! The clouds hang low o'er the Rim and the pines drip silver, but no true Nord lets a

little sky-water dampen his spirits — for this is Faire Week, and the holds are about to burst their seams with merriment. Come Thursday the Northern Gila County Fair thunders into the Payson Event Center with bull

riders, barrel racers, and mutton-bustin' younglings, and on Friday the first-ever North Inch Renaissance Faire raises its banners at the Payson Golf Course — three full days of pyrates, faeries, bagpipes, and turkey legs the size of a troll's forearm. Between the showers, Prescott's artists throw open their studio doors and Ottmar Liebert's guitar takes the Elks stage. Pull thy cloak close, friend — the week ahead is worth every drop.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

-  **Payson**
— **Sit & Stitch** — bring thy handcrafts or come learn crochet at the [Payson Public Library](#), 2 PM
-  **Pine**
— **Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose** — pickers and singers at [THAT Brewery & Pub](#), 4–7 PM; all tips benefit PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction
-  **Sedona**
— **Olive Oil Tasting** — an afternoon tasting in Sedona, 4 PM ([details](#))
— **928 LIGHTWERK: Monday Night Dance Party** — West Sedona shakes off the rain at 7:30 PM ([listing](#))
-  **Show Low**
— **Free Line Dancing Mondays** — kick up thy boots at [The Lions Den Bar & Grill](#), 4 PM
-  **Prescott**
— **Hand and Foot Canasta** — cards at noon ([details](#))
— **BINGO** — Monday-night balls at the [Jersey Lilly Saloon](#), 6 PM

THE DAYS AHEAD

- **Tuesday, Sept. 29**
— **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — join PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction to clear brush, move rocks, and shape trail along Hwy 87 in Pine, 7 AM–noon; tools provided, email trails@psfuelreduction.org to lend thy hands ([details](#))

- **Wednesday, Sept. 30**
— **Musicians with Heart Open Mic** — local pickers and singers take the stage at the Jersey Lilly Saloon in Prescott, 7 PM; all are welcome to play or simply listen ([details](#))

- **Thursday, Oct. 1**
— **Northern Gila County Fair & B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival** (Oct. 1–3) — the county fair thunders into the [Payson Event Center](#): pro bull riding, ranch rodeo, barrel racing, mutton bustin', junior livestock auction, live music, rides, and vendors through Saturday

- **Friday, Oct. 2**
— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** (Oct. 2–4) — the big one, friends! Payson's brand-new Scottish-village faire takes over the [Payson Golf Course](#) for its inaugural year with a Pirate & Faerie Festival theme — three full days of bagpipes, costumes, crafts, and turkey legs the size of a troll's forearm, Fri 9 AM–5 PM, Sat 9 AM–9 PM, Sun 9 AM–5 PM. A whole new realm rising in the Rim in the very season the Hearth itself takes shape — the Dude insists thou go and raise a toast to new beginnings.
— **Prescott Area Artist Studio Tour** (Oct. 2–4) — 74 artists open 52 private studios plus three art centers across the Prescott/Quad-City area, 10 AM–4 PM daily; free and self-guided ([details](#))

- **Saturday, Oct. 3**
— **Ottmar Liebert & Luna Negra** — the Grammy-nominated nouveau flamenco guitarist brings his band to the historic [Elks Theatre in Prescott](#), 7 PM
— **Prescott Valley Fall Fest** — family fun at the Prescott Valley Civic Center, 11 AM–4 PM ([details](#))

- **Sunday, Oct. 4**
— **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — the weekly market fills the Wells Fargo lot at 2201 W SR 89A in West Sedona, 8 AM–noon ([details](#))

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Two days past its due date — measure the flame bulb and socket, then sketch the design. The forge grows restless.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Saturday — two torches plus the socket test piece, then test-fit. Print, and the walls shall have light.

The sconce design tarries two days past its due — finish the design and print by Saturday, and the Hearth's torches take their place upon the walls!



Shaping the torch sconces at the workbench, with the Hearth shield and door timbers close at hand.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Paul's Ace Hardware & Hearth Shoppe · Payson



The workshop counter at Paul's, where every tool has a tale.

Payson's locally owned hardware haven — the closest thing to a blacksmith's forge in the holds. STIHL power equipment sales and service, small-engine repair, key cutting, glass and lumber cut to size, paint matching, lock servicing, and screen repair, plus a Hearth Shoppe and seasonal nursery out back. The signature move: the staff talk you through the repair instead of just selling you the part.

"Love this place. They have a great selection of items and the staff is very friendly and helpful." —

[Loc8NearMe review](#)

507 N Beeline Hwy, Payson
— Mon–Sat 7 AM–7 PM,
Sun 9 AM–5 PM — (928)
474-5238 — moderate prices
— senior & military
discounts, and they're open
Sundays. · [their website](#)

Why the Hearth sends

you: Because when a Hearth project needs a bolt, a blade, or a bit of honest advice, this is where the Hearth sends you.

JETHRO THE SCARECROW



Jethro holds his scarecrow pose in Mabel's rain-soaked herb garden while Earl supervises.

Mabel (a wood elf) has exactly one rule about her herb garden: nobody tromps through it. So when she found Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) standing knee-deep in her raised beds at sunrise, arms spread wide in the pouring rain and smiling fit to split, she did what any responsible adult would do — she sighed so hard the rain bent sideways.

“I’m a scarecrow!” Jethro announced proudly, rain streaming off his shaggy chin. “For the crows.” Mabel pointed out, gently, that no crow in its right mind flies in this weather. Jethro nodded like this proved his point.

Earl (an elk) wandered over to supervise, because somebody had to witness this with dignity, even soaked. He stood getting rained on with tremendous poise while Mabel weeded around Jethro’s enormous feet, muttering about “volunteer labor with no neck and no sense.”

Then a single crow dropped out of the gray sky onto Jethro’s head — not to mock him, but to get out of the rain. Jethro went perfectly still. The crow fluffed itself smugly beneath his brow. Jethro whispered, “It’s working,” and smiled so wide the crow slid clean off his rain-slicked head into the basil.

Mabel fished it out, sighed again, and planted an extra row of carrots “for the help.” Jethro ate them on the spot. Scarecrows get hungry, especially damp ones.